

For Gonachi, I recommend a **two-way verified rating system** that is simple for users but structured enough to produce meaningful ratings. Because these ratings can affect housing opportunities and reputations, the system should emphasize **specific, first-hand, tenancy-related conduct**, with moderation and a dispute process.

Gonachi Landlord & Tenant Rating System

1. Universal 5-star scale

Use the same scale throughout the platform:

Score	Label	Meaning
★★★★★	5 Excellent	Consistently exceeded reasonable expectations
★★★★	4 Very Good	Met expectations with only minor issues
★★★	3 Satisfactory	Generally met reasonable expectations
★★	2 Poor	Significant problems occurred
★	1 Very Poor	Serious or repeated problems occurred
N/A	Not Applicable	User did not experience or cannot assess this area

I would require users to select **N/A** rather than guessing about something they did not experience.

2. Landlord rating criteria

I recommend **8 core categories**.

Criterion	Weight	Question shown to tenant
Property Condition & Maintenance	20%	How well was the property maintained during your tenancy?
Repairs & Responsiveness	20%	How responsive was the landlord/property manager to legitimate repair and maintenance requests?
Communication	15%	How clear, timely and professional was communication?

Criterion	Weight	Question shown to tenant
Lease & Financial Transparency	15%	Were lease terms, rent, fees, utilities and other charges clearly communicated?
Privacy & Entry Practices	10%	Did the landlord appropriately respect your privacy and applicable entry/notice requirements?
Safety & Security Response	10%	How appropriately did the landlord respond to property safety or security concerns?
Issue Resolution	5%	How effectively were tenancy-related concerns addressed?
Move-In/Move-Out Experience	5%	How organized and professional was the move-in/move-out process?
Total = 100%		

The public profile could then display:

Landlord Rating: 4.5/5

Maintenance **4.7** · Responsiveness **4.3** · Communication **4.6** · Transparency **4.5**

This gives future tenants much more useful information than one generic star score.

3. Tenant rating criteria

For tenants, I recommend criteria that are especially objective and behaviour-based.

Criterion	Weight	Question shown to landlord
Payment Reliability	25%	Were rent payments made in accordance with the tenancy agreement or an agreed payment arrangement?
Property Care	20%	Did the tenant take reasonable care of the property, excluding normal wear and tear?
Communication	15%	Was communication timely, respectful and constructive?

Criterion	Weight	Question shown to landlord
Lease Compliance	15%	Did the tenant generally comply with applicable and lawful tenancy obligations?
Maintenance Reporting	10%	Did the tenant appropriately report maintenance or property concerns?
Reasonable Access Cooperation	5%	Did the tenant reasonably cooperate with properly arranged lawful access?
Tenancy/Community Conduct	5%	Were legitimate tenancy-related conduct expectations generally respected?
Move-Out Cooperation	5%	Was the tenancy transition handled reasonably and cooperatively?

Total = 100%.

Important payment distinction

Do not simply ask:

"Did the tenant always pay rent on time?"

Instead ask whether payments were made **according to the tenancy agreement or another mutually agreed arrangement.**

That distinction matters because a tenant and landlord may legitimately agree to an alternative payment arrangement.

4. Written reviews

After the star ratings, provide an optional comment box:

Tell us about your experience

Describe your first-hand experience. Focus on specific tenancy-related events and avoid personal information, insults, threats, discriminatory statements or allegations you cannot substantiate.

I would also provide optional structured tags.

For landlords:

Responsive to repairs · Professional communication · Well-maintained property · Clear lease terms · Good move-in experience

For tenants:

Reliable payments · Good communication · Property well maintained · Cooperative with maintenance · Smooth move-out

Structured tags can eventually become valuable searchable data for Gonachi.

5. Verified reviews

This could become one of Gonachi's strongest differentiators.

Display:

✓ Verified Tenancy

only when Gonachi has reasonably established that a landlord-tenant relationship existed.

Verification could potentially come from a lease, platform transaction, mutually confirmed tenancy, property association, or another appropriate verification method.

However, don't publicly expose the underlying lease or personal documents.

Profiles could show:

4.7 ★ — 18 reviews

15 Verified Tenancies

A verified review should carry more credibility than an unverified review.

6. Prevent retaliatory ratings

This is important for a two-sided marketplace.

Consider a **double-blind review system**: after a tenancy ends, both parties can submit reviews during a defined period, such as 14 or 30 days. Neither party sees the other's review until both have submitted—or until the review period expires.

This reduces:

"You gave me one star, so I'm giving you one star."

Gonachi could display:

Review submitted — Your review will be published after the other party submits theirs or when the review period closes.

7. Overall score calculation

Your developer can implement the weighted calculation:

Overall Rating = Σ (Category Rating × Category Weight)

For example, suppose a landlord receives:

Maintenance = 5

Repairs = 4

Communication = 5

Transparency = 4

Privacy = 5

Safety = 4

Resolution = 4

Move-out = 5

The result would be:

So the profile displays **4.5/5**.

N/A categories should be removed from the denominator and the remaining applicable weights normalized automatically.

8. Minimum reviews before showing a public score

I would avoid presenting a single review as though it establishes someone's reputation.

For example, after one rating:

5.0 ★ — 1 review

Limited rating history

Once sufficient ratings accumulate, the platform can display the normal composite score.

Also show the **number of reviews prominently**. A 4.6 based on 47 verified tenancies conveys something very different from a 5.0 based on one review.

9. Disputed reviews

Every review should have:

Report Review

Possible reasons could include:

- I did not have a tenancy relationship with this person.
- Contains false factual information.
- Contains discriminatory or hateful content.
- Contains threats or harassment.
- Contains private/personal information.
- Contains irrelevant information.
- Conflict of interest.
- Other.

A reported review shouldn't necessarily disappear automatically. Gonachi can place it into moderation and apply its published review policy consistently.

For serious factual disputes, the platform could request supporting information from the parties privately.

10. Right of response

Give landlords and tenants the ability to post **one professional response** to a review.

For example:

Landlord response: "We acknowledge the maintenance delay described in this review. The repair required a replacement part, and the issue was subsequently resolved."

This is preferable to allowing unlimited arguments underneath reviews.

11. Information that should NOT be rated

I would build this directly into the software rules.

For tenants, don't create rating categories around **race, ethnicity, nationality, citizenship/immigration status, religion, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, age, family status, marital status, receipt of public assistance, pregnancy, medical conditions or other legally protected/personal characteristics.**

Also avoid categories such as:

"Quality of tenant"

"Desirable tenant"

"Good family"

"Employment quality"

"Cultural fit"

Those are vague and can introduce discrimination into housing decisions.

12. Don't turn the tenant score into an automatic approval system

This is particularly important.

I would **not** design Gonachi so that:

Tenant score below 3.5 = automatically reject rental application.

A reputation/review feature and a formal tenant-screening or eligibility decision are different functions.

Instead, present the underlying categories and context and allow appropriate housing decisions to be made in accordance with applicable law.

13. Recommended profile design

A landlord profile could look like:

JOHN D. — LANDLORD

★★★★☆ 4.6 / 5

27 Reviews · 22 Verified Tenancies

Property Maintenance 4.8

Repair Responsiveness 4.5

Communication 4.7

Lease & Financial Transparency 4.6

Privacy & Entry Practices 4.5

Frequently mentioned:

Responsive · Professional · Well-maintained · Clear communication

Recent Verified Reviews

★★★★★

"Maintenance requests were handled promptly and communication was clear throughout my tenancy."

✓ **Verified Tenancy**

And a tenant profile:

MARY A. — TENANT

★★★★☆ 4.7 / 5

8 Reviews · 7 Verified Tenancies

Payment Reliability 4.9

Property Care 4.8

Communication 4.6

Lease Compliance 4.7

Maintenance Reporting 4.5

Frequently mentioned:

Reliable · Communicative · Property well maintained

✓ **Verified Tenancy History**

For privacy, I would seriously consider limiting how much tenant rating information is publicly searchable compared with landlord/property reviews.

14. A feature I would add: Gonachi Trust Profile

Rather than making everything depend on stars, you could eventually create a **Gonachi Trust Profile** composed of separate factual indicators:

✓ **Identity Verified**

✓ **Tenancy Verified**

✓ **Property Relationship Verified**

✓ **Email Verified**

✓ Phone Verified

12 Completed Tenancies/Transactions

4.7/5 Community Rating

Keep these as separate indicators rather than collapsing identity, verification and subjective reviews into one opaque "trust score."

That gives Gonachi a potentially strong marketplace feature: **reputation + verification + transparency**, while still allowing users to understand *why* someone has a particular rating.

For your developers, I would build the database so that **individual category scores, verification status, review text, review date, tenancy/transaction ID, report status, response, jurisdiction, and moderation status are stored separately**. That will make it much easier to modify the scoring model later without rebuilding the entire review system.